CLASS 10 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 13: **Power-sharing (Political Science)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Which statement correctly differentiates community government from regional government in Belgium? 1

(a) Community government is based on territory
(b) Regional government is elected by language community
(c) They are identical
(d) Community government is based on language community wherever they live; regional government is based on territory

2. Which is the best example of horizontal power sharing in India? 1

(a) Parliament passes a law and the Supreme Court can review it
(b) A party forms an alliance
(c) The Centre and States share subjects
(d) A panchayat elects a sarpanch

3. Assertion (A): Reserved constituencies are a form of power sharing among social groups. Reason (R): They give space to weaker sections in government who would otherwise feel alienated. 1

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

4. In which situation is power sharing not being practised? 1

(a) Different organs act as checks
(b) Parties form a coalition
(c) Provincial governments have fixed powers
(d) One leader controls all organs of government

5. Which is likely to be the long-term result of a majority forcing its will on others? 1

(a) Greater trust **(b)** A federal system
(c) More stable government **(d)** Weakened unity of the nation

6. Concentrating all political power in one person or group goes against which basic principle of democracy? 1

(a) people are the source of all political power
(b) judges should be elected
(c) parties should be banned
(d) the executive should be strong

7. Assertion (A): Power sharing between the Union Government and State Governments is called vertical division of power. Reason (R): It involves governments at higher and lower levels. 1

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

8. A state proposes that every law must be approved by a majority of members from each language group. This resembles: 1

(a) a coalition
(b) a Sri Lankan majoritarian act
(c) the Lebanese rule
(d) a Belgian safeguard

9. **Assertion (A):** The Belgian model of power-sharing has helped the country remain united. 1
Reason (R): In Belgium the Constitution requires equal numbers of Dutch and French-speaking ministers in the central government and gives community governments powers over cultural, educational and language matters.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

10. **Assertion (A):** In Sri Lanka the Sinhala-speaking community forms the majority of the population. 1
Reason (R): The Sinhala-speaking community of Sri Lanka lives mainly in the north and east of the island.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. What would be the effect on a country if one organ of government became more powerful than others? 2

12. Is the statement 'power sharing = dividing power = weakening the country' supported by the chapter? 2

13. Which of the two stories shows an accommodation and which shows majoritarianism? 2

14. Why can a coalition government face difficulties? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Evaluate: 'A country that divides power is a weak country.' 3

16. Differentiate between a unitary and a federal government using Belgium's change in 1993. 3

17. How might a federal arrangement have helped Sri Lanka? 3

OR

Justify the statement that democratic power sharing needs trust. 3

18. Evaluate the argument that accommodation is complicated and therefore not useful. 3

OR

Why is the 'moral' argument for power sharing connected to democracy's meaning? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. **Case study.** Belgium has a small population of about 1 crore. Of its people, 59 per cent live in the Flemish region and speak Dutch, 40 per cent live in the Wallonia region and speak French, and the rest speak German. In the capital Brussels, 80 per cent speak French and 20 per cent speak Dutch. The minority French-speaking community was relatively rich and powerful. 5
(i) Which language is spoken by the majority in Belgium?
(ii) Which language is spoken by most people in Brussels, and how does this differ from the country as a whole?
(iii) What problem arose as the Dutch-speaking people became better off?
(iv) How did Belgium solve its problem?

20. Analyse how Sri Lanka's civil war could have been avoided according to the chapter's reasoning. 5

OR

Evaluate why both prudential and moral reasons support power sharing. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks